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Culture (OWC): [San \(FX10\)](#)

Region: Africa

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Place Coverage

!Koi!kom, Central Kalahari Game Reserve, Botswana

Section Title(S)

1. Visiting Occasions at Camp P (Visitor Sample)

(5) Affiliative body contact	574 Visiting And Hospitality
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In 27.3 percent (6/22) of the Visitor Samples, grooming interactions occurred between female visitors and female residents. All of these grooming episodes occurred in the groups which included 2 or more female visitors and residents, respectively. Thus the gathering of many women brings about a comfortable atmosphere which enables the participants to be involved in such prolonged and hedonic face-to-face interaction as grooming (Sugawara, 1984).	515 Personal Hygiene
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The second type of physical contact to be noticed is called *giba-ku*, which means 'sit in contact with each other'. When two participants are involved in the *giba-ku* interaction, both sit cross-legged and one puts their thigh and knee on another's thigh. The typical pattern of *giba-ku* is frequently observed between the residents of the same sex in very affiliative relationships with each other. In the context of visiting, the most interesting is the *giba-ku* interaction between siblings-in-law of the opposite sex.

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Kin Relationships

Marshall (1976) maintains that the joking relationship is applied to siblings-in-law of the opposite sex among the !Kung San. But my previous study affirmed that bodily contact rarely occurred among these dyads within the camp (Sugawara, 1984). However, if a woman's brother-in-law is living in another camp, affiliative body contact, i.e., *giba-ku*, often occurs between them when he visits her camp. In a case from the Visitor Sample (V1), it was observed that a male visitor from Camp KJ sat in contact with his sister-in-law and enthusiastically talked with her, patting her right knee with his right fist.

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Kin Relationships

Another verb, *nya:tsa*, is almost synonymous with *giba* (sit in contact with), but is often used in a more distinctively sexual context. A man with sexual ambition may *nya:tsa* ('caress') a woman whom he is thinking of, and, if she rejects his intention, she may cry, "Do not touch me" (*Kyua kya nya:tsa*). A typical *nya:tsa* interaction as a form of 'petting' was observed in an anecdotal case between an adolescent male visitor and an adolescent female resident within the latter's hut. They lied side by side and the girl wreathed her legs around the boy's waist or rubbed his hip. Afterward the boy pinned her to the sand and thrust his knee into her thighs and pushed her groin with his palm. It is judged that they were merely playing with each other jokingly, because they neither showed any signs of sexual excitement nor did they mind my presence at all. Anyhow, the most important point implied by *giba-ku* and *nya:tsa* interactions is that the visiting is a specific social occasion in which the sexual potential of visitor-resident relationships can be realized.

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Sexual Stimulation

The third type of bodily contact occurs in a distinctive pattern of interaction called *//gaikari-ku*. Typically, *//gaikari-ku* means the play fighting between adolescent or pubescent boys which is performed in a way similar to a boxing match, but the verbal exchange of jokes or quasi abuse is also referred to by the same term. Namely, *//gaikari-ku* represents the most exact behavior for the 'joking relation'. Although the *//gaikari-ku* interaction occurred between resident and visitor in only 22.7 percent (188 (5/22) of the Visitor Sample, it was often observed anecdotally when the adolescent men visited Camp P.

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